

IPOMOEA

Triangular-ovate leaves are divided into 7–15 segments. Tubular, wide-mouthed, crimson flowers with white eyes are borne in summer. Z10–11 (min. 45°F/7°C)

***I. nil* ‘Early Call’**. Short-lived, soft-stemmed, perennial, twining climber with hairy stems, best grown as an annual. H to 12ft (4m). Leaves are heart-shaped or 3-lobed. From summer to early fall bears large, funnel-shaped flowers in a range of colors, with white tubes. Z10–11. (min. 45°F/7°C). **‘Scarlett O’Hara’** has bright red flowers.

I. purpurea, syn. *Convolvulus purpureus* (Common morning glory). Short-lived, soft-stemmed, perennial, twining climber, best grown as an annual, with hairy stems. H to 15ft (5m). Leaves are heart-shaped or 3-lobed. From summer to early fall produces funnel-shaped, deep purple to bluish-purple or reddish flowers with white throats and bristly sepals. Z10–11 (min. 45°F/7°C)

I. quamoclit, syn. *Quamoclit pennata*, illus. p.202.

I. rubrocaerulea. See *I. tricolor*. ***I. x sloteri***. See *I. x multifida*.

I. tricolor, syn. *I. rubrocaerulea* (Morning glory). Fast-growing, twining annual or short-lived perennial. H 10–12ft (3–4m). Has ovate to heart-shaped, slender-tipped, light to mid-green leaves, 1½–4in (4–10cm) long. Funnel-shaped, bright sky-blue to purple flowers, to 3in (8cm) across, with white tubes, golden yellow inside at the bases, are borne in summer. Z10–12. (min. 45°F/7°C). **‘Electric Mixed’**, H 4–6ft (1.2–1.8m), has white, pink, mauve, purple or blue flowers throughout summer. **‘Flying Saucers’** has variably marbled, white and purple-blue flowers.

‘Heavenly Blue’ illus. p.205. **‘Star of Yalta’**, H 6ft (2m), has neon blue flowers. **‘Venetian Mixed’**, H 4–6ft (1.2–1.8m), is vigorous, bearing blue-and-white- or pink-and-white-striped flowers.

I. tuberosa. See *Merremia tuberosa*. ***I. versicolor***. See *I. lobata*.

IPOMOPSIS

POLEMONIACEAE

Genus of perennials, biennials and annuals, often grown as potted plants for greenhouses and conservatories. Grow in cool, airy conditions with bright light and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown under glass in early spring or summer.

I. aggregata. Slow-growing biennial with upright, slender, hairy stems. H to 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Mid-green leaves are divided into linear leaflets. Fragrant, trumpet-shaped flowers, borne in summer, are usually red, sometimes spotted yellow, but may be rose, yellow or white. Z6–9

IREesine

AMARANTHACEAE

Genus of perennials, annuals and subshrubs, grown for their colorful leaves. Requires bright light to retain leaf color and a good, loamy, well-drained soil. Pinch out tips in growing season to obtain bushy plants. Propagate by stem cuttings in spring.

I. herbstii (Beefsteak plant). Bushy

annual or short-lived perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has red stems and rounded, purplish-red leaves, notched at their tips and 4in (10cm) long, with paler or yellowish-red veins. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12. **‘Aureoreticulata’** illus. p.319.

I. lindenii (Bloodleaf). Bushy perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, dark red leaves, 2–4in (5–10cm) long. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12

IRIS

IRIDACEAE

Genus of upright, rhizomatous or bulbous (occasionally fleshy-rooted) perennials, some of which are evergreen, grown for their distinctive and colorful flowers. Each flower has 3 usually large “falls” (pendent or semipendent petals), which in a number of species have conspicuous beards or crests; 3 generally smaller “standards” (erect, horizontal or, occasionally, pendent petals); and a 3-branched style. In many irises, the style branches are petal-like. Unless otherwise stated below, flower stems are unbranched. Green, then brown seed pods are ellipsoid to cylindrical and often ribbed.

Irises are suitable for borders, rock gardens, woodlands, watersides, bog gardens, alpine houses, cold frames and containers. Some groups may thrive only in the specific growing conditions mentioned below. Propagate species by division of rhizomes or offsets in late summer or by seed in fall, named cultivars by division only.

Botanically, irises are divided into a number of sub-genera and sections, and it is convenient, for horticultural purposes, to use some of these botanical names for groups of irises with similar characteristics and requiring comparable cultural treatment. ☉ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested; contact with the sap may irritate skin. See also feature panel pp.224–225.

Rhizomatous irises

These irises have rhizomes as rootstocks, close to or on the surface, or just below ground level, which produce sword-shaped leaves, usually in a basal fan. Each active rhizome produces several new growths every year, and this spread can continue indefinitely. As a rough guide, in 3 years a small iris can attain a spread of 12in (30cm), and a tall one a spread of 2ft (60cm). Rhizomatous irises are categorized in the following groups:

Bearded irises are rhizomatous and have “beards,” consisting of numerous often colored hairs, along the center of each fall. In some irises, the end of the beard is enlarged into the shape of a horn. The group covers the vast majority of irises, including many named cultivars, grown in gardens; all are derived from *I. pallida* and related species. Bearded irises thrive in full sun in fairly rich, well-drained, preferably slightly alkaline soil. Some are very tolerant and will grow and flower reasonably in partial shade in poorer soil. For horticultural purposes, various groupings of hybrid bearded irises are

recognized, based mainly on the height of the plants in flower. These include: **Miniature Dwarf**, H to 8in (20cm); **Standard Dwarf**, H 8–16in (20–40cm); **Intermediate**, H 16–28in (40–70cm); and **Tall**, H 28in (70cm) or more (this last category may be further subdivided). In general, the shorter the iris, the earlier the flowering season (from early spring to early summer).

Oncocyclus irises are rhizomatous, with very large and often bizarrely colored flowers, one to each stem, which have bearded falls. They require full sun, sharply drained but fairly rich soil and, after flowering, a dry period of dormancy in summer and early fall. Difficult to cultivate successfully, they are best grown in an alpine house or covered frame in climates subject to summer rains.

Regelia irises are closely related to *Oncocyclus* irises, differing in having bearded standards as well as falls and in having 2 flowers to each stem. They require similar conditions of cultivation, although a few species, such as *I. hoogiana*, have proved easier to grow than *Oncocyclus* irises. Hybrids between the 2 groups have been raised and are known as **Regeliocyclus** irises.

Beardless irises, also rhizomatous, lack hairs on the falls; most have very similar cultural requirements to bearded irises but some prefer heavier soil. Various groupings are recognized, of which the following are the most widely known.

Pacific Coast irises, a group of Californian species and their hybrids, prefer acidic to neutral soil and grow well in sun or partial shade, appreciating some humus in the soil; they are best grown from seed as they resent being moved.

Spuria irises (*I. spuria* and its relatives) grow in sun or semishade and well-drained but moist soil. A number of species and hybrids prefer moist, waterside conditions; these include the well-known Siberian irises (*I. sibirica* and its relatives) and the **Japanese** water irises, such as *I. ensata* and *I. laevigata*, which may also be grown as border plants, but succeed best in open, sunny, humus-rich, moist positions.

Crested irises are also rhizomatous and have ridges, or cockscomb-like crests, instead of beards. They include the **Evansia** irises, with often widely spreading, creeping stolons. Most have very similar cultivation requirements to bearded irises but some prefer damp, humus-rich conditions.

Bulbous irises

These irises are distinguished by having bulbs as storage organs, sometimes with thickened, fleshy roots, and leaves that are lance-shaped and channeled; 4-sided (more or less square in cross section); or almost cylindrical—unlike the flat and usually sword-shaped leaves of the rhizomatous irises. All are summer dormant. Bulbous irises fall into 3 groups: **Xiphium** irises include the commonly grown Spanish, English and Dutch irises, which are excellent for garden decoration and as cut flowers. All are easy to cultivate in sunny, well-drained sites, preferring slightly alkaline conditions, but also growing well on acidic soil. **Spanish** irises

are derived from *I. xiphium*, which is variable in flower color, from blue and violet to yellow and white, and produces its channeled leaves in fall.

English irises have been produced from *I. latifolia*, which varies from blue to violet (occasionally white) and produces its channeled leaves in spring. **Dutch** irises are hybrids of *I. xiphium* and the related pale to deep blue *I. latifolia*. They are extremely variable in flower color.

Juno irises have bulbs with thickened, fleshy roots, channeled leaves and very small standards that are sometimes only bristlelike and usually horizontally placed. Although very beautiful in flower, they are mostly difficult to grow successfully, requiring the same cultivation conditions as *Oncocyclus* irises to thrive. Care must be taken not to damage the fleshy roots when transplanting or dividing clumps.

Reticulata irises include the dwarf, bulbous irises, valuable for flowering early in the year. Unlike other bulbous irises, they have netlike bulb tunics and leaves that are 4-sided, or occasionally cylindrical. With few exceptions (not described here), *Reticulata* irises grow well in open, sunny, well-drained sites.

I. ‘Action Front’. Rhizomatous bearded iris (Tall). H 34in (85cm). From late spring to early summer, produces flowers with mauve-brown standards and deep mahogany-red falls, each with a golden yellow beard and white veins. Z3–9

I. acutiloba. Rhizomatous *Oncocyclus* iris. H 3–10in (8–25cm). Has narrowly sickle-shaped, mid-green leaves. In late spring, produces solitary, strongly purple-violet- or brownish-purple-veined, white flowers, 2–3in (5–7cm) across, with a dark brown blaze around the beard of each fall. Z13–15

I. albicans. Rhizomatous, bearded iris. H 1–2ft (30–60cm). Has broadly lance-shaped, gray-green leaves, 18in (45cm) long. In late spring, unbranched stems bear 1–3 fragrant white flowers, 3½in (9cm) across, with yellow-tipped white beards. Z6–8

I. ‘Alida’. Bulbous *Reticulata* iris. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 1½–2½in (4–6cm). In early spring, bears a solitary, fragrant, long-tubed, light blue flower, 1½–2½in (4–6cm) across, with a yellow ridge down each fall center. Z13–15

I. ‘Alizes’. Vigorous, rhizomatous, bearded iris (Tall). H 32in (80cm). In summer, large, frilly white flowers are produced with violet-blue falls that pale to white in the center of the petals. The flowers have yellow beards. Z13–15

I. ‘Amber Queen’. Dwarf bearded iris. H 10in (25cm). In early summer, bears flowers with deep yellow standards and amber-flushed falls, with golden-yellow beards. Z5–8

I. ‘Annabel Jane’. Vigorous, rhizomatous, bearded iris (Tall). H 4ft (1.2m). Well-branched stem produces 8–12 flowers, 6–10in (15–25cm) across, with pale lilac falls and paler standards. Flowers in early summer. Z4–9

I. ‘Anniversary’. Rhizomatous, beardless Siberian iris. H 30in (75cm). In mid- and late spring, bears 1–4 white flowers, 2–4in (5–10cm) across, with a yellow stripe in the throat of